the cacao spirit

a guide to working with mama cacao

alex faraday · @alexfaraday_

what it is (and isn't).

cacao is a complex superfood and plant medicine, high in iron, magnesium and antioxidants.

she's often called **mama cacao**, and her gentle spirit is known for offering loving guidance.

she is psychoactive, **not psychedelic**. you stay in your body and fully in control, simply rooted in the present moment.

why we use it in ceremony.

people have been drinking cacao for around 6,000 years, calling in her spirit during sacred rituals and spaces of healing and connection.

cacao brings us into the present moment, opens our energetic channels, and connects us to our intuition. she brings us closer to who we truly are, **not who we're told to be.**

why it supports grounding & presence.

cacao contains **theobromine**, a natural stimulant that helps open the heart space and connect you back to your inner guide.

it also carries **phenylethylamine** (the 'love chemical') and **anandamide** (the 'bliss chemical').

after drinking cacao, your heart may feel warm and maybe beat a little faster or louder. this is completely normal.

cacao vs. cocoa.

when it's processed minimally, cacao is plant medicine, an incredibly complex superfood and a powerful antioxidant.

when it's processed further, refined and mixed with other ingredients, it becomes what we know as cocoa or chocolate.

'ceremonial grade'.

cacao has become a trend, and unfortunately not all 'ceremonial grade' cacao is the real thing.

true ceremonial grade cacao is grown and harvested in a way that honours both the plant medicine and the land it comes from. it's minimally processed to keep its psychoactive compounds.

to keep her spirit alive and safe, always work with pure cacao, from brands who work directly with native cacao farmers.

contraindications.

if you have a heart condition, high blood pressure, a sensitivity to fermented foods, or you're taking antidepressants, please speak to a medical professional before drinking ceremonial grade cacao.

pregnant or breastfeeding? cacao is generally considered safe, but check with your midwife or doctor first, and start with a lower dose to see how baby responds.

how i work with it.

most mornings, to ground, find stillness and set my intention for the day ahead.

in ceremony, to go deeper, understand better and remember who i really am.

how to prepare your ceremony space.

the idea is to create a space that feels cosy, heartwarming and welcoming for you.

some things you might want nearby: candles, crystals, incense or herbs, a soft toy, a plant, or anything that feels grounding.

more than anything, make sure you're comfortable. pjs are highly recommended.

how to prepare your cup of cacao.

how you prepare it depends on the cacao you're using:

block: chop finely, add water, then melt it down in a saucepan or use a blender.

buttons: add water and melt down in a saucepan.

step by step.

1. play some grounding music, and maybe burn your favourite incense or herbs to cleanse the space. these little rituals bring blessings and good energy to the plant medicine.

2. mix 25–28g of cacao with 200ml of water. some people add plant milk for a thicker drink, but never use animal milk.

3. add other flavours if you like: cinnamon, clove, cayenne, rose or sea salt. my favourite is dried bird's eye chilli for some heat.

if using a blender.

1. pop the kettle on while you chop the cacao, and get any other ingredients ready.
2. add your cacao and extras to the blender, and pour in 200ml of hot, not boiling, water.
3. make sure the lid is on securely and nothing can leak or squirt out, then blend for around 15 seconds.

if melting down.

1. add water and your cacao to a small saucepan and heat low + slow, making sure your cacao melts fully.
2. don't let it boil! heating too fast splits the natural fats, so it turns oily, and it damages the psychoactive compounds.
3. once steam rises and you can smell the cacao, take it off the heat.

continued.

while you prepare it, pay close attention to the cacao. watch it, pour love into it and thank it in advance for the presence and grounding she's about to bring you. believe me, this makes all the difference to her magic.

cacao is quite bitter, so you might want to sweeten it with raw honey. add it after heating, so you don't damage the honey's goodness.

pour your medicine lovingly into your favourite mug, settle into your space, and set your intention before drinking slowly and intentionally.

important.

avoid coffee, tea and any other stimulants before ceremony.

fasting for 2–3 hours beforehand will likely deepen the experience.

try to avoid dairy for up to 12 hours after drinking cacao, and drink plenty of water through the day.

never feel you have to finish the whole cup. your body will tell you when it's had enough.

questions.

i hope this guide has helped you understand cacao, her spirit, and how to prepare for sacred ceremony.

if you're feeling called to sit with cacao, **the ritual** is my online ceremony, held every couple of months. a safe space of stillness, self-reflection and sisterhood.

and **the ritual 1:1** is a private, completely personalised ceremony where you can discover cacao's magic at your own pace.

if either of these spaces is calling you, head to **alexfaraday.com** or send me a dm: **@alexfaraday_**

cacao meets you where you're at: leading you to the door, and letting you choose whether or not to step through.